Overview

This submission compiles the outputs from three prompt engineering tasks carried out in a text-to-image generator. The tasks were designed to test baseline prompting, prompt expansion for professional quality, handling of trigger words, and negative prompt phrasing.

Simple task summary table:

Task	Objective
Task one	Compare basic prompts with detailed prompts for higher professional fidelity
Task two	Work around trigger words by substituting descriptive attributes
Task three	Test negative prompts versus positive re-framing for removing unwanted elements

Task one. Basic vs detailed prompts

Task one compares two prompt structures for two subjects. For each subject, a basic prompt is used first without modification. A second attempt uses an expanded prompt that includes lighting, composition, texture, and camera language.

Prompts used and Generated images and captions

Image 1. Wizard. Basic prompt result. Prompt: a wizard elderly wizard in flowing dark blue robes, intricate silver embroidery, holding a wooden staff, soft studio lighting, portrait photography style

Image 2. Mountain landscape. Basic prompt result. Prompt: mountain landscape snow-capped mountain peaks at sunrise, golden light, wispy clouds, telephoto lens, crisp detail, 4k

Image 3. Wizard. Detailed prompt result. Prompt: elderly wise wizard, long flowing white beard, wearing deep dark blue robes with intricate silver embroidery and subtle arcane symbols, holding a detailed wooden staff with glowing runic carvings, calm and powerful expression, cinematic soft studio lighting with gentle rim light, shallow depth of field, ultra-realistic skin texture, fine fabric detail, portrait photography style, 85mm lens, high dynamic range, 8k resolution, professional character photography, fantasy realism

Image 4. Mountain landscape. Detailed prompt result. Prompt: majestic mountain landscape with snow-capped peaks at sunrise, warm golden hour lighting casting soft highlights and long shadows, dramatic sky with wispy clouds, atmospheric depth with light mist in valleys, ultra-realistic textures, sharp focus, telephoto lens compression, cinematic composition, high dynamic range, crisp details, 8k resolution, professional landscape photography style

What worked

Detail control improved with explicit attributes. In the wizard comparison, the detailed prompt result shows stronger material separation, with robe embroidery reading as more complex and the beard and hair carrying more volume. In the landscape comparison, the detailed prompt result shows more distinct depth planes and atmospheric perspective, supporting a cinematic sense of scale.

Lighting intent translated reliably. Terms such as golden hour, rim light, and HDR corresponded to clearer highlight direction and a more deliberate tonal structure across both subjects.

What did not work

Some highly specific elements were only partially realised. In the wizard detailed prompt, glowing runic carvings are not strongly visible on the staff , suggesting that emissive effects may be deprioritised compared with overall realism cues. In the landscape detailed prompt, the intended resolution increase to 8k is not verifiable from the supplied preview shots, and micro-texture fidelity cannot be judged conclusively.

Unexpected results

The basic prompts still produced visually coherent, professional-looking images. This indicates that the model has strong default priors for common subjects such as wizard portraits and sunrise mountains. The more detailed prompts increased control, but also nudged the aesthetic toward a narrower, cinematic style, which may not always be desired.

Technical notes (lighting, composition, camera terms)

Lighting. “Soft studio lighting” produced even illumination and low shadow drama, while the detailed portrait prompt increased contrast and edge separation through cinematic lighting language. In landscapes, golden hour language aligns with warm highlights and long shadow reads. Image additionally shows stronger haze and atmospheric scattering consistent with mist in valleys.

Composition. Both landscape outputs use diagonal ridge lines to lead the eye. The detailed prompt version emphasises a dominant peak and layered depth, which reads as more intentionally composed. Portrait framing is mid-shot in both cases, but the detailed prompt yields a darker background envelope that increases subject separation.

Camera terms. “Telephoto lens compression” is consistent with stacked mountain planes and reduced depth spacing. Portrait lens language (85mm) is typically associated with flattering compression and shallow depth of field, but the neutral backgrounds and downscaled previews limit how strongly this is visible.

Task two. Trigger-word workarounds

Task two tests workarounds for trope-heavy prompt language. Each pair includes a problematic trigger prompt and a solution prompt that avoids the trigger nouns and instead specifies behaviour, atmosphere, lighting, and materials.

Prompts used and Screenshots provided in this submission

Image 5. Pair one workaround screenshot. Prompt used: humanoid figure in fluid motion, dark environment with colourful spotlights, dynamic pose, metallic surface reflections

Image 6. Pair two workaround screenshot. Prompt used: misty woodland at dawn, small points of bioluminescent light between trees, ethereal atmosphere, soft bokeh effect

What worked

The workaround prompts successfully conveyed mood and action without relying on explicit trope nouns. In Image the pose reads as dynamic and dance-like, and the metallic surfaces show strong specular reflections consistent with the material language. In Image the scene reads as dawn-lit and misty, with glow points that communicate bioluminescence and depth.

What did not work

Some cliché elements were inferred despite omission. Image 5 introduces a nightclub crowd silhouette, stage rigging, and laser beams that were not explicitly requested. It also renders the humanoid subject as distinctly robotic, implying that metallic descriptors can reintroduce the robot archetype. Image 6 includes small luminous shapes that can be read as fairy-like entities rather than purely abstract points of light.

Unintended elements observed

Pair	Unintended elements visible in screenshot	Why they likely appeared
Pair one	Silhouetted crowd, stage lights, laser-like beams, overt robot styling	Dark scene plus colourful spotlights strongly implies club staging. Metallic reflections encourage robot interpretation
Pair two	Fairy-like glowing shapes, pronounced fantasy mood	Dense luminous particles plus ethereal language can be interpreted as small animated entities

How the solution prompts avoided clichés

Pair one. The solution prompt avoids the words “robot” and “nightclub”. It replaces them with a behaviour descriptor (fluid motion), environmental lighting descriptors (dark environment, colourful spotlights), and material cues (metallic reflections). This shifts the prompt from a label into a scene description. The output still borrows nightclub staging because the lighting cues strongly anchor that context.

Pair two. The solution prompt avoids the explicit fantasy entity noun “fairies”. It replaces it with lighting and atmosphere cues such as bioluminescent points, mist at dawn, and bokeh. This encourages a photographic, mood-driven woodland rather than character-driven fantasy. Residual fairy-like shapes suggest the model’s tendency to personify clustered glow particles.

Technical notes

Workaround design pattern. Replace trope nouns with measurable attributes. Use materials, motion, and lighting. Where a scene context is still desired, define it through physical cues rather than a genre word. This reduces some defaults but does not fully remove them when the remaining cues strongly imply the same setting.

Task three. Negative prompt practice

Task three tests three versions of an abandoned street prompt and then an improved prompt. The goal is to evaluate which undesirable elements can be removed by negative phrasing and whether positive re-framing produces more consistent results.

Prompts used

Variant	Exact prompt
Version one	abandoned city street

Version two	abandoned city street, no people

Variant	Exact prompt
Version three	abandoned city street --no people, no graffiti, no trash, no animals
Improved prompt	clean empty urban street, minimalistic architecture, well-maintained surfaces, no signs of decay

Compare images

Image shows a narrow, decayed street with abandonment cues, including graffiti, worn surfaces, scattered debris, and sporadic vegetation. Image 8 shows a clean, minimal urban boulevard with modern façades, clear sightlines, and no visible decay artefacts.

The improved prompt therefore achieves stronger removal of unwanted elements by redefining the target concept rather than negating it.

Elements successfully removed

Element	Observed in Image (abandoned)	Observed in Image (clean)
People	No	No
Graffiti	Yes	No visible graffiti
Trash or debris	Yes	No visible trash
Animals	None visible	None visible
Surface decay	Yes (cracks, wear)	No visible decay cues

Unexpected differences

The improved prompt changes the narrative category of the scene. For many models, “abandoned” implies disorder and neglect. Removing those cues shifts the scene toward a maintained business district or architectural visualisation. This is a favourable trade when cleanliness is the goal, but it can be undesirable if the assignment requires the street to still read as abandoned.

Technical notes

Negative prompts are often soft constraints. A model may still include semantically associated artefacts when they are strongly coupled to the scene concept. Positive re-framing avoids this conflict by selecting a concept whose typical visual co-occurrences match the intent.

Key learnings about prompt structure

Structure matters. A practical ordering is subject, action, environment, lighting, materials, camera language, and final quality cues. Adding these elements tends to reduce ambiguity and compress the model’s solution space.

Resolve semantic conflicts early. If the base concept implies unwanted attributes, avoid long exclusion lists. Instead, reframe the concept toward a scene that naturally lacks the unwanted elements.

Use camera terms as constraints, not decoration. Lens and lighting language can be powerful, but may over-style the output. Apply them when you need consistent framing and lighting rather than when you want exploratory variety.